



Instagram Stories

Instagram has decided to extend the Snapchat-style Instagram Stories to the explore tab. <http://dgit.in/ExplrIS>

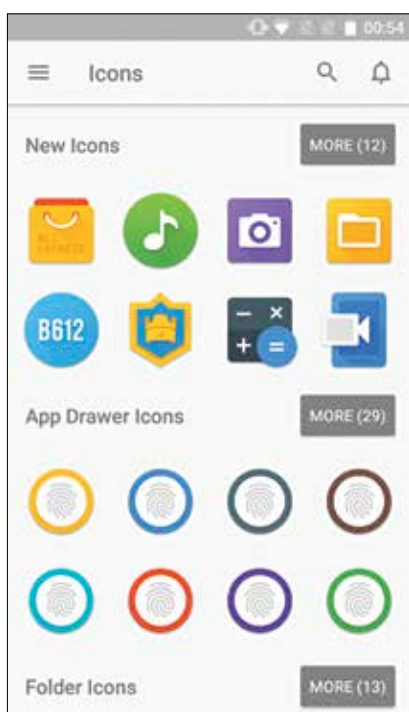


LinkedIn workforce

LinkedIn's workforce is more diverse than last year, says workforce diversity metrics. <http://dgit.in/LIDvrse>

genmod, you get the privilege of an in-built theme manager. Cyanogenmod (CM) ROMs are published with a high-level of tweaking, offering an insane amount of customisation. This is the case with several custom ROMs such as Paranoid Android, Resurrection Remix and OmniROM. Before we speak about Xposed, we'll explain how convenient it is to play around with the themes available on the Play Store.

Once you've installed CM on your phone, the CM Theme Manager lets you search for theme packs, icons,



fonts, wallpapers, lockscreen wallpapers, boot animations and sounds. But make sure that you're searching for the right and compatible version of themes, otherwise they won't run properly. For example, if you have CM13 installed, then you should install CM13 themes and styles only.

Arcus

Another important app that you should install is Arcus – an asset replacement manager to individually select the necessary assets and accordingly build a theme. Arcus also makes it easier for themers to build different variants of the same theme to suit a wider user

base. For example, a themer can build a theme in more than one colour variant, or with a different icon pack variant, etc. You can download Arcus from the Play Store and search for supported free and paid themes within the app.

Link: <http://dgit.in/ArcusThm>

Substratum

What was earlier called Layers Manager, now is being overhauled as Substratum. Still under development, it's quite an ambitious project to make applying themes and replacing assets easier. This theme engine is more detailed and granular than CM's version. CM themes aren't compatible through this engine, obviously, so you'll have to install Substratum supported themes only.

Link: <http://dgit.in/SubstratumThm>

Xposed Framework

So far, the methods were applicable to CM users only and in case you're on a stock OS, you'll need to install the Xposed Module, and you'll obviously need root access. The entire Xposed Framework is a set of modules that lets you tinker around and customise the behaviour of your system and system apps. It's an endless list of modules, which deserves an entire story to itself covering the best modules. For theming, we'll be looking at only a few such as Gravity Box and XBLast.

Do note, that these modules are intended only for AOSP ROMs or vanilla ROMs which ship with Nexus and a few Motorola phones. If you're already on a custom ROM among the ones mentioned above, avoid using these modules since these ROMs already come with a lot of customisation and overriding them through these modules might send your phone into a bootloop.

Installing Xposed Framework is straightforward, where you'll have to flash the zip file and install the Xposed apk. You can find detailed instructions here: <http://dgit.in/XposedInstll>. After installing, head over to the Download tab and search for the above mentioned modules. Download, install and then reboot your phone to complete

the installation and then you should have the corresponding apps appear in your drawer.

GravityBox

The main purpose of GravityBox is to enhance AOSP ROMs by inserting customisations which are usually seen in custom ROMs. Although most of the modules included inside GravityBox are also available individually in Xposed, the app lets you have everything in one single place. Before installing, make sure you're downloading the right GB since there are different modules for different Android versions. Be sure to check out the corresponding support threads in case you have any queries on installation here: <http://dgit.in/GBMMxda>. The advantage here is you don't need to reboot every time you install a module, rather tweaks can be switched on or off on the fly. There are a ton of options inside, and if you thought that the number of Xposed modules were crazy, GB will completely blow your mind.

XBLast

This is another module that includes yet more tweaks to your system. There will be few settings that might overlap with GB or another system tweaking tool, so make sure that you don't mess around with the same setting in different modules. XBLast includes extra options of playing around with the hardware buttons, the text that appears in system icons, network tweaks, etc.

Once you employ the above steps, you'll also be exploring a lot of different methods and apps that help you in changing and tweaking with the look of your phone. If done right, you can completely transform your dull and ugly looking UI into a beautiful one, without harming your phone. But if you want to go the extra mile and fiddle with system settings, then go completely crazy with Xposed Framework. If you found this workshop useful and actually tried out any of the above steps to change the way your smartphone UI looks, do send us a few screenshots of your revamped UI to editor@digit.in